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X/HHShkMohd

MOHAMMED LAUNCHES DH100 BILLION ZABEEL DISTRICT AT DIFC

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, yesterday announced the launch of the second phase of the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC), a Dh100 billion expansion. Also seen are Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council and Sheikh Maktoum Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, First Deputy Ruler of Dubai and Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Finance of the UAE.

SEE ALSO P-1

EU and India agree to ‘mother of all deals’

EU CHIEFS, MODI SEE PACT AS SHIELD AGAINST CHALLENGES

NEW DELHI

India and the European Union announced yesterday the “mother of all deals”, a huge trade pact to create a market of two billion people, reached after two decades of negotiations.

EU chiefs and Prime Minister Narendra Modi hope the pact will help shield against challenges from the world’s two leading economies, the United States and China.

The agreement will cut or eliminate tariffs on almost 97 per cent of European exports, saving up to €4 billion (\$4.75 billion) annually in duties, the 27-nation bloc said.

“A mother of all deals,” Modi said yesterday in the capital New Delhi, where he met with European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen and European Council President Antonio Costa.

Many opportunities

“This deal will bring many opportunities for India’s 1.4 billion and many millions of people of the EU,” Modi said, adding the agreement “represents about 25 per cent of global GDP, and one-third of global trade”.

“Europe and India are making history today,” Von der Leyen said in a statement, a day



AP

Narendra Modi, centre, celebrates with Antonio Costa and Ursula von der Leyen after signing the deal in New Delhi.

after she and Costa were feted as guests of honour at India’s Republic Day parade.

“We have created a free-trade zone of two billion people, with both sides set to benefit.”

Europe’s key agricultural, automotive and service sectors stand to gain.

New Delhi sees the European bloc as an important source of much-needed technology and investment to rapidly upscale its infrastructure and create millions of new jobs.

Under the agreement, India is expected to ease market access for key European products.

Tariffs on cars will be gradu-

ally lowered from a top rate of 110 per cent to as low as 10 per cent, while duties on wines progressively go down from 150 per cent to as low as 20 per cent.

Currently at 50 per cent, tariffs on processed foods — including pasta and chocolate — will be eliminated, according to the EU. European firms will get privileged access to the Indian financial services and maritime transport market, the bloc said.

For India, it would boost sectors including textiles, gems and jewellery, and leather goods, as well as the service sector, Modi said.

— AFP

SEE ALSO P6

World’s 1st ‘Gold Street’ in Dubai Gold District

New district to feature street as part of retail, trade development

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

Ithra Dubai has announced plans to build what it described as the world’s first “Gold Street” as part of the newly launched Dubai Gold District, a purpose-built destination bringing together gold retail, bullion trading and wholesale activity in one location.

Developers said the Gold Street will be constructed using gold elements and is intended to form a central attraction within the district. Detailed design and construction plans will be released in phases.

Single destination

The announcement was made during the official unveiling of Dubai Gold District, attended by Mohammed Ibrahim Al Shaibani, managing director of the Investment Corporation of Dubai; Mohammad Ali Rashed Lootah, president and chief executive of Dubai Chambers; Dr Juma Al Matrooshi, assistant to the secretary general of the Dubai

Gold Street will sit within a wider development that consolidates gold and jewellery retail, wholesale trading, bullion services and investment-linked businesses in a single destination.

Free Zones Council; and Issam Galadari, chief executive of Ithra Dubai. Ithra Dubai said the Gold Street will sit within a wider development that consolidates gold and jewellery retail, wholesale trading, bullion services and investment-linked businesses in a single destination.

The district comprises more than 1,000 retailers across gold, jewellery, perfumery, cosmetics and lifestyle categories. Brands operating in the area include Jawhara Jewellery, Malabar Gold and Diamonds, Al Romaizan and Tanishq Jewellery. Joyalukkas has announced plans to open a 24,000-square-foot flagship store, which it said will be its largest in the Middle East.

Developers said the Gold Street is designed to complement the district’s retail and trading infrastructure rather than operate as a standalone attraction.

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